MICHELLE GONZÁLEZ AMADOR

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Wageningen University & Research, Postdoctoral Researcher *2024 - 2027*
Agricultural Economics and Rural Policy Group (AEP):
Education, Human Capital Investment in LMICs.

UNU-MERIT & Maastricht University, Research Consultant *2023 - 2024*
Innovations for Policy Analysis: Machine Learning, Experimentalism.

International Labour Organization, Consultant *2018 - 2019*
Research and monitoring strategy: Youth Aspirations and the Future of Work.

Education Global Practice, World Bank Group, Consultant *2016 - 2017*
Quantitative Research, monitoring, inter-agency project collaboration: University Governance Score Card.

Internships, OECD's EMEA Desk, UNECE's Population Unit *2012; 2014*
Research: African Economic Outlook 2012;
Chapter 8 "Mainstreaming Ageing in Georgia" UNECE publication.

EDUCATION

UNU-MERIT & Maastricht University School of Business and Economics, Netherlands
PhD in Innovation, Economics and Governance for Development
Promotor: Robin Cowan *2016 - 2024*

Stanford University, Visiting Researcher *Summer 2024*
Stanford Impact Labs: Equitable Access to Education Lab. Design of Evaluation and Analysis strategy.
Advisor: Irene Lo

Hertie School of Governance, Germany *2013 - 2015*
Master of Public Policy - Policy Analysis and Economic Development concentration
Advisor: Mark Hallerberg

Sciences Po Rennes, France *2010 - 2011*
Certificat D'Études Politiques

Tec de Monterrey, Mexico *2008 - 2013*
Bachelor of International Affairs

SKILLS

Languages
Spanish (C2)
English (C2)
French (B2)
German (A2)

Software & Programming
R, Python, Julia, LaTeX, STATA, JavaScript, CSS & HTML, Quarto, Git

Other
Project Management, Inter-Agency Collaboration, Public Communication, Policy Brief & Report Writing, Field Survey & Web App Development

SOFTWARE & WEBSITES

Education Equity Technology, with Edwin Lock *2025*
Offline-first tablet web app (JavaScript, Flask) for enumerator-led surveys and lab-in-the-field experiments, with built-in school-level randomisation. Used for a parental allocation task with randomised scenario order in 16 schools in San Luis Potosí, Mexico. Source code.

C-SEF, with Simon Finster and Edwin Lock *2022 - 2023*
Web app implementing the welfare-maximizing pooled testing algorithm and running the field experiment described in Finster et al. (EC'23), at IPICYT, Mexico.

Websites developed & maintained
- ml4publicpolicy.com: open-source course, Machine Learning for Public Policy *Since 2022*
- dev-econ.nl: Dutch Development Economics Network (DuDe) *Since 2025*
- VIC: bilingual site (Next.js, D3) for the Verano Internacional de la Ciencia *2026*
- curso-ia-slp.com: *Intro a la IA*, online AI course for high-school students *2026*

TEACHING

Master of Public Policy and Human Development, UNU-MERIT/Maastricht University
Lecturer & teaching assistant
- Machine Learning for Public Policy *2022 - 2025*
- Introduction to Data Science and Statistics *2017 - 2023*
- Public Policy *2022*
- Public Policy Analysis (Impact Evaluation) *2017 - 2018*
- Econometrics: Regression Analysis I & II *2019 - 2021*

Bachelors in Economics and Business Economics, SBE - Maastricht University
Teaching Assistant
- Network Economics *2021*

High-school students, San Luis Potosí, Mexico (WUR, YouiLab, IPICYT)
Course designer
- Intro a la IA: 15-session online course, with guest live sessions *2026*

AFFILIATIONS

Association for Computing Machinery (**ACM**); Network Science Society (**NetSci**); Dutch Development Economics Network (**DuDe**).

WORKSHOPS

- Gentle Introduction to R for Network Analysis. UNU-MERIT PhD Program. *2019 - 2020*
- Gentle Introduction to Overleaf and LaTeX. GPAC^2 PhD Program. *2022*

INVITED TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

- Nederlandse Economendag (NED'26), The Hague. *Labor Market Returns to Education and Intra-family Educational Inequality: Theory and Experimental Evidence.* *2026*
- Invited Talk, NetSci4SDGs: Network Science for the Sustainable Development Goals, NetSci 2025 Satellite Symposium, Maastricht. *Network Science for Development: an overview with a focus on Quality of Education (SDG4).* *2025*
- Co-panelist, Winter International School on Research in Communications and Social Sciences - Latin America (WIRSS'21). *2021*

CONFERENCE ORGANISATION & ACADEMIC SERVICE

- Co-organiser, EAAMO'25 Local — Oxford, satellite of the ACM Conference on Equity and Access in Algorithms, Mechanisms, and Optimization. Linacre College, Oxford: three-day programme with four keynotes and contributed talks; hosted Indigenous researchers from the EAAMO-REDNACECYT Summer of Science. *2025*
- Panel Organiser, J-PAL and EAAMO: Equity and Inclusion of Emerging Indigenous Scientists and Local Partners. ACM Conference on Equity and Access in Algorithms, Mechanisms and Optimization (EAAMO'24), San Luis Potosí. *2024*
- Co-chair, Diversity and Inclusion: Geographical Inclusion. ACM Conference on Equity and Access in Algorithms, Mechanisms and Optimization (EAAMO'21). *2021*
- Working Group Co-organiser, MD4SG - Latin America and Caribbean (MD4SG.com). *2021 - 2023*
- Program Committee Member, ACM Conference on Equity and Access in Algorithms, Mechanisms and Optimization (EAAMO'22 & EAAMO'23). *2022-2023*
- Seminar Organizer, METECH Seminars for technical skills, UNU-MERIT IEGD PhD Program). *2017 - 2021*
- Invited participant, ODI international roundtable - AI & Infrastructure - Experimentalism & 4IR. *2022*
- Co-organiser: EAAMO-REDNACECYT Indigenous Women Summer of Science Programme. *2020 - ongoing*

MSC. THESIS SUPERVISION

MSc. Public Policy & Human Development, UNU-MERIT
Sten Ritterfeld, Erin Loutitt, Gabriela Cervantes Valerezo, Jessica van Wijgerden, Bansi Popat, Danila Viano, Giorgos Oikonomides, Juan Pablo Alvarez Vega, Alexandra 'Alessa' Haller, Leopoldo Pérez Obregón, Felix Märtin, Alex Mayiopoulos, Nandini Das.

MSc. Machine Learning, IPICYT
Gloria Edith Palacios Almón

RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS

Dissertation
González Amador, M. (2024). *Learning in low and middle-income countries: essays on education and development economics*. Doctoral Thesis, Maastricht University. doi:10.26481/dis.20241021mg

Published Research
Finster, S., **González Amador, M.**, Lock, E., Marmolejo-Cossío, F., Micha, E., and Procaccia, A.D. (2023). Welfare-Maximizing Pooled Testing. *Proceedings of the 24th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation* (EC'23). arXiv:2206.10660
Exemplary Track Paper Award - Applied Modeling
Journal version submitted: Operations Research

Gardiner, D., Goedhuys, M., and **González Amador, M.** (2021). Youth aspirations and the future of work. **Book Chapter.** In: *Is the future ready for youth?* International Labour Organization, Geneva. `http://www.oit.org/wcmsp5/groups/public/---ed_emp/documents/publication/wcms_790120.pdf`

Working Papers
González Amador, M., Cowan, R., and Nillesen, E. Peer Networks and Malleability of Educational Aspirations. *Submitted: Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics*. Earlier version: arXiv:2209.08340

Gehrke, E. and **González Amador, M.** Labor Market Returns to Education and Intra-family Educational Inequality: Theory and Experimental Evidence. Lab-in-the-field experiment with parents in Mexico; presented at NED'26. Pre-registration: AEA RCT Registry 17183-1.0

Okolo, C.T. and **González Amador, M.** IAC: A Framework for Enabling Patient Agency in the Use of AI-Enabled Healthcare. arXiv:2111.04456

Finster, S., **González Amador, M.**, Lock, E., Marmolejo-Cossío, F., and Merone, S. "Fighting the Learning Loss: Evaluating C-SEF for University Students and Staff". *Analysis phase*. Pre-registration: AEA RCT Registry 9466-2.0

Ongoing Field Experiments
Cash Transfers, Training and Savings Groups in Rural Rwanda. With Erwin Bulte and Clement Uwizeye.
Cluster-randomised trial in 90 villages (1,800 households), Nyamagabe, Nyamasheke and Rusizi districts: cash only vs. cash + training + VSLA. Baseline completed; first transfers made in 2026.

Work in Progress
The Income Gradient of Between-Sibling Educational Inequality. With Esther Gehrke and Tomohisa Miyamoto.

Networks and Human Capital. Solo-authored.

Social Networks in Rwanda: Network Architecture and Village Dynamics. With Erwin Bulte and Clement Uwizeye.
Village census of trust and support networks: 16,343 households in 90 villages.

Machine Learning and Tax Base in Developing Countries. With Rose Vincent.

Willingness to Donate in an Emergency: From the Global North to the Global South. With Simon Finster and Edwin Lock.

Educational Resilience in Times of Crisis: State policies, aggregate shocks and students' educational resilience in Peru.

GRANTS AND AWARDS

NWO SSH Open Competition XS (2026)
€49,992 as Co-applicant for 'Technological progress and social mobility: Schooling choices when wage-returns to education are convex'. Dutch Research Council (NWO), file no. 406.XS.26.02.107.

Exemplary Track Paper Award (2023)
24th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation
Awarded to: Finster, S., **González Amador, M.**, Lock, E., Marmolejo-Cossío, F., Micha, E., and Procaccia, A.D. for "Welfare-Maximizing Pooled Testing".

DUS-I International Collaborative Virtual Project Grant (2023-2024)
€15,000 as Principal Investigator for 'Machine Learning for Public Policy'.

MEDIA AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

Featured Research
Supporting indigenous women researchers to flourish
UNU-MERIT Summer of Science Program
`https://www.merit.unu.edu/summer-of-science-program/`
Programme coverage: Harvard SEAS (2023); Harvard ReVista (2024); La Jornada San Luis

SIGecom Exchanges
Welfare-Maximizing Pooled Testing, Vol. 22(1), 2024
ACM Special Interest Group on Economics and Computation